



Delaware County Council September 23rd, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7S-f3H7Pjhl
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Final Budget Hearing [00:00:04](#)
- **Summary of Discussion:** The council convened to review and vote on final budget resolutions prior to the regular meeting. Resolutions for the airport budget (Resolution 2025-017) and the county budget (Resolution 2025-016) were discussed, voted on via roll call, and successfully approved. The budget hearing was then adjourned.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular September Delaware County Council meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at approximately 9:05 AM [02:04:49](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Brookout, Mr. Flangen (Flanken), Mr. Smoggle (Mole/Mogul), Mr. Hughes, Mr. Can (Gance/Sciance), Mr. Piper, Mr. Whitehead (Sweethead), Mr. Freeman.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks, but leading the agenda.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Ben led the assembly in the Pledge of Allegiance [02:02:57](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the August 26 council meeting were approved with minor spelling corrections by voice/roll call vote [05:04:42](#).
 - **Agenda Amendments:** A request was made to add Resolution 2025-15 (the "give back resolution") to the agenda [03:44:48](#). The motion to add the resolution passed by roll call vote, followed by the approval of the amended agenda.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [05:42](#) **County General Transfers (Courts - Fund 138)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Emily
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds totaling zero net change (\$8,425 total transfer). Covers an additional grommet for a juvenile court upgrade (\$225), jury chairs (\$7,278.60), and a micro PC for recording/evidence equipment (\$730 with extra room for memory upgrades).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [08:04](#) **Motor Vehicle Highway Transfers (Fund 1176)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Katie
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$88,219 from health insurance lines to vehicle leases due to lower-than-expected state funding under local roads and streets and savings from open/unfilled positions in health benefits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [09:31](#) **Appropriation: Delaware Fair and Expo (Fund 4911)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Donna
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$2,000 (\$1,000 for office supplies like receipt books, and \$1,000 for operating supplies like toiletries and cleaning supplies).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [10:41](#) **Appropriation: Statewide 911 (Fund 1222)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$60,000 for equipment representing the final radio console added to the center as part of a multi-year plan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [11:30](#) **Appropriation: Drug-Free Community Fund (Fund 1148)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jennifer Moore, Executive Director
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$31,500 in grant funds to be redistributed during Red Ribbon Week across 10 local organizations tackling local overdose and drug issues.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **12:38 Appropriation: EMS Capital Improvement (Fund 4910)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$10,000 for other capital outlays to cover utility costs (Constellation) pending billing resolution.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **13:32 Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance Amendment**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve financial transfers into and amend the salary ordinance with like reductions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **16:47 Ordinance 2025-14: Rainy Day Fund Ordinance (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ben / Council Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed edits to the 30-day ordinance. Key amendments included:
 - Modifying Section 4(B) to include “emergency repairs”.
 - Striking “state-mandated” from Section 4(C) regarding computer hardware/software.
 - Striking non-payment property tax restrictive verbiage from Section 4(E).
 - Striking subsections (B) and (D) entirely from Section 5 to remove finance committee denial/appeal hurdles and align review with standard council appropriation procedures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for second reading as amended by roll call vote.
- **25:39 Resolution 2025-15: Reduction of Funds (“Give Back” Resolution)**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal resolution reflecting department fund reductions/givebacks identified during budget hearings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **35:51 Rick Yanser** (Newsman and author): Addressed the council regarding public transparency around the budget process. Expressed concern over the lack of accessible budget resolution copies prior to the meeting, questioned tax increases and property tax relief narratives, highlighted cash balances across various funds (general fund, TIF, ARRA/Stewardship monies), and urged compliance with public records requests given rising assessed property values.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- **Dormant Fund Update:** Council discussed closing the dormant Inheritance Tax Fund (Fund 7202, holding ~\$6,258.94) via future ordinance/resolution to transfer remaining funds to the rainy-day fund.
- **CHIRP Grant Update:** Captain Tony Johnson (Sheriff's Office) reported a fiscal year 2026 highway enforcement/traffic safety grant approval of \$124,200, which will come before the council next month.
- **ADA Transition Plan:** Kylen Swackhammer (Plan Commission) announced the completion of the Delaware County ADA Transition Plan (assessing 8 county facilities), funded in part by community and foundation grants, with digital copies available online.
- **Auditor & Budget Team Recognition:** Auditor and council members thanked staff for their work implementing the OpenGov platform and managing a rigorous budget season.
- **Agricultural Notice:** Council members reminded community members to exercise patience with slow-moving farm equipment as the autumn harvest season begins.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Jessica and a second by Dan, approved by roll call vote [04:47:43](#).

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